

Department of Economics
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December 18, 2025

Search Committee
Department of Economics
Barnard College
New York, NY
USA

Dear Members of the Search Committee,

I am writing to apply for the Lecturer of Economics position at Barnard College, as advertised on Workday. I am a Ph.D. candidate in Economics at Johns Hopkins University, advised by Professors Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis, and I expect to complete my degree in May 2026. I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to contribute to Barnard's undergraduate-focused economics program through high-quality, student-centered teaching in a liberal arts environment.

My teaching experience includes *Principles of Macroeconomics*, *Intermediate Macroeconomic Theory*, and upper-level electives that emphasize policy applications and empirical evidence. My approach to teaching prioritizes clarity, economic intuition, and active engagement, with a strong emphasis on connecting economic models to real-world questions that resonate with students. I place particular value on creating inclusive classroom environments where students from diverse academic backgrounds feel supported and encouraged to develop confidence in economic reasoning. These priorities align closely with Barnard's mission and its emphasis on close faculty-student interaction, rigorous undergraduate education, and mentoring.

While my primary professional focus for this position is teaching, my research background informs my classroom instruction. My research lies at the intersection of macroeconomics, heterogeneous-agent models, and wealth inequality, using micro data to study how economic risk and heterogeneity shape aggregate outcomes. I find that incorporating insights from current research—without overwhelming students with technical detail—helps motivate core concepts and fosters deeper engagement with economic ideas, particularly at the introductory and intermediate levels.

Barnard College is an especially appealing academic community for me because of its strong commitment to undergraduate education, its intellectually engaged student body, and its location within a vibrant academic ecosystem through its relationship with Columbia University. I am particularly drawn to Barnard's emphasis on discussion-based learning and its tradition of faculty mentorship, and I would welcome the opportunity to contribute to the department's curriculum, advising, and broader academic life as a dedicated lecturer.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. I would be delighted to discuss my application

and qualifications further.

Sincerely,

Decory Edwards